

PowerDB Forms Design FAQ

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Form Design Basics	
1.	Changes to forms and subforms must be done in a development database and then the form must be moved to the master database. To create a development database from the master database go to the DATABASE tab and select New Database>New Development DB. To connect to this new database select Change Database and browse. Unless specified otherwise, all of the FAQ tasks in this document must be performed in a development database and then uploaded into a master database to be used.
2.	Once connected to a development database and logged in as either an administrator or form designer you can edit forms and subforms. Select the FORM LIBRARY tab and then choose Show Forms or Show Subforms from the ribbon.
3.	If you wish to modify a file in the Form Editor we suggest you Copy/Paste the file and modify the pasted file indicated by (2) at the end of the name. The file name can be modified from the right-click, Rename menu item.
4.	Once an updated or new form has been finalized and tested, it can be moved to the master database in either of two ways. 1) Right-click on the form name and select “Upload Form to Master” to perform a single form synchronization, or 2) Right-click on the form name and select “Export Form (.pxd). Go into the master database and select the FORM LIBRARY tab and choose Import Form PXD > Import Single Form PXD.

How do I change the tab order of a test form?	
1.	Select the FORM LIBRARY tab.
2.	In the Forms navigation tree, double click on a test form to open it. The form will be visible in the workspace portion of the window.
3.	Click in a blank portion of the form workspace, then right-click. a. To change the entire tab order to a left to right, top to bottom sequence select Auto Define Tabs. b. To modify the existing tab order, select Define Tab Order. Hold down the Ctrl key and click on the control preceding the needed change. Release the Ctrl key and begin clicking the controls in the desired tab order.
4.	Click the Save toolbar button.

How do I change a logo?	
1.	Create and save a BMP, JPEG or GIF file of your logo using graphics software such as Adobe Photoshop or Microsoft Paint, or use an existing BMP file. It is recommended that the overall dimension should be 400 pixels wide and 240 pixels high.
2.	Open the Subform editor.
3.	To change the left side logo, locate and double click subform Logo 1. To change the right side logo, double click subform Logo 2.
4.	Double click in the center of the subform to display the Image Properties dialog box.

5.	Click on the Insert button to select your logo file. The first file name displayed in the Image Properties image list will be the graphic displayed on all forms.
6.	Click OK.
7.	Click the Save toolbar button.

How do I add a new form?

1.	Open the Form editor.
2.	Click on the New toolbar button.
3.	Complete the steps in the wizard dialog boxes. You may specify how the form is to be named in the Job Tree and Print Results dialog by entering the appropriate text in the Form Name edit box of the last screen of the wizard. Click Finish to add the new form. View the navigation tree for the new form.

How do I modify a form?

1.	Open the Form editor.
2.	Select a form in the tree and double click it or right-click and select Open to enter design mode.
3.	To add a new control to the form select a tool from the Form Controls panel on the ribbon. Drop the control onto the form by clicking in the workspace.
4.	To move a control in the workspace, click in the control and drag, or use the arrow keys.
5.	To resize a control, click in the control and catch the sides or corner handles and drag to expand.
6.	To delete a control, click in the control. Right-click and choose Delete or hit the delete key. The system will prompt you to confirm the delete instruction.
7.	Double click on a control to open its Properties dialog box.

How do I copy scripts from one row to all rows of a table?

1.	Select one of the cells in the row you wish to copy.
2.	Right-click on the cell and click on the Select Row menu item.
3.	Right-click on any cell and select the Copy Scripts menu item.
4.	Click OK to acknowledge PowerDB's instruction to click the bottom right cell of the area you wish to copy to.
5.	Press and hold the Shift Key.
6.	Left click on the bottom right cell of the area you wish to copy scripts to.
7.	Release the Shift key.
8.	Right-click on any cell.
9.	Select the Paste Scripts menu item.

How do I locate a VBScript error when editing a form?	
1.	The VBScript Error dialog box displays the line number and a brief description of the error encountered. Note the line number and click OK until the error message goes away.
2.	Click on the Scripts button in the Form Scripts panel. Select View Master Script.
3.	Click Ctrl+G and enter the Line number, or scroll or hit the Page Up and Page Down keys and locate the line number listed in the error message. You will be able to view the scripting and determine a control or function to correct. If information such as t1345_l570_r640_b1375 is indicated, these are the top, left, right and bottom workspace coordinates of the control with the error.

How do I set up and title a new form?	
1.	Open the Form Editor.
2.	Click on the New toolbar button.
3.	Complete the steps in the wizard dialog boxes. You may specify how the form is to be named in the Job Tree and Print Results dialog by entering the appropriate text in the Form Name edit box of the last screen of the wizard. Click Finish to add the new form. View the navigation tree for the new form. Double click to open the new form.
4.	PowerDB automatically inserts two controls and places these in the upper of the workspace. Click OK at the prompt to open the form in design mode. When viewing the workspace, blank areas are displayed as a snap grid used by the application for sizing and alignment. The red horizontal and vertical lines indicate the margins.
5.	Click on the Insert button in the Form Controls panel and select Subform. Click and drag in the workspace to drop the subform control onto the workspace. Double click on the control to open its Properties dialog. Select 'Header' from the dropdown list and click OK. Click in the control and move it to align with the top margin and the left edge of the paper. Select Test Form in the View panel or right-click in the workspace and select Test in the menu to view your changes.
6.	Scroll down to the bottom of the test form. Repeat Step 5 and select 'Footer' from the dropdown list and click OK. Click in the control and move it to align with the bottom margin and the left edge of the paper. Repeat again and select 'Comments' from the dropdown list and click OK. Click in the control and move it to align it immediately above the Footer subform. Select Test Form in the View panel or right-click in the workspace and select Test in the menu to view your changes.
7.	In a blank area of the workspace hold the shift key and double click to open the Form Properties scripts, or from the right-click menu select Properties then Scripts. In the On Initial Update tab add the following instructions: <pre>.FormName = "MY NEW FORM" InternalFormNum = "9999"</pre> In the Global tab add the following instruction: <pre>dim InternalFormNum</pre> Select Test Form in the View panel or right-click in the workspace and select Test in the menu to view your changes.

How do I copy/paste a form and rename it?	
1.	In the Form Definitions tree, right-click Copy, then right-click Paste the selected form. It will be added to the tree below the original form appended by (2).
2.	Rename the form in the tree from the right-click menu. Modify the title of the form in the Form Properties On Initial Update tab.

How do I troubleshoot a script error?	
1.	PowerDB will prompt you as to script errors when you switch between design and test mode in the forms editor. The Line refers to the line of script in the master scripts and briefly describes the error. Corrections must be made to the offending control.
2.	To view the master script go to the Form Scripts panel and select Scripts > View Master Scripts or press Alt+F9. The line number is displayed in the lower left corner. You may scroll or page down and click in the text area to get to the error line. The instruction line above the error line will display the workspace coordinates of the offending control, make note of the 't' (top) and 'l' (left) coordinates as these are displayed in the lower left screen of the form design workspace in the format (Left, Top).
3.	You can insert Message Boxes to pop up to assist in scripting. Enter the following: Msgbox "Message to display" You can log text to a log file by entering the following: Call LogMsg("Message to display") All logged messages are stored in Pdb.log text file and appended to the end of the file. If you are running an anti-virus application you may be prompted regarding the logging, respond to allow the script. Remove or disable all log messages once the test form design is completed. You can open the application log from the Logs panel on the HELP tab.
4.	You can change the calculation depth (number of times the scripts are executed after the form is opened and executed once) at Form Properties.

What do the control script tabs mean?	
1.	On Initial Update - The very first time the form is opened the scripts in these controls will be carried out.
2.	On Update - Every time there is any type of change on the form the scripts in these controls are carried out.
3.	On Select - Every time a control with an On Select script is selected the respective scripts are carried out.
4.	On Enter - On Enter scripts are automatically run when the form is initially loaded (for the purpose of initializing dependent calculations) and also when controls that contain these scripts are modified. Controls that have this property will carry out the scripts when the respective field has data entered in to it.
5.	On Right-click - On Right-click scripts are run when the control is right-clicked.

What do the control property types mean?	
1.	Job Specific - Data is saved and pre-populated on any other form in this job.
2.	Manufacturer - Special nameplate field, equipment manufacturer information previously entered is maintained in the database and made available at data entry.
3.	Model - Special nameplate field, equipment model information previously entered for a manufacturer is maintained in the database and made available at data entry.
4.	Nameplate - Data will pre-populate every test for this asset and similar test forms in the same family; will be considered like assets for trending.
5.	Settings - Data will pre-populate every test for this asset and similar test forms in the same family; will be considered like assets for trending.
6.	Copy History - Data will pre-populate every test for this asset and similar test forms in the same family; will not be considered like assets for trending.
7.	Data - Data from the current test only, does not transfer between tests.
	NOTE: Manufacturer and Model types are not recommended since data entries are saved in a database table but are not able to be edited.

How do I initialize cells in a table?	
1.	Add a table with 3 columns and 11 rows.
2.	Select the first row, and double click to open the Multiple Items Properties dialog or select Properties from the right-click menu.
3.	To label the first row as 'No., Volts and Amps' enter the following in the Initial Value edit box: ##<No.,Volts,Amps> Click OK.
4.	To initialize the labels '1-10' in the first column below the existing label 'No.', select these cells and double click to open the Multiple Items Properties dialog or select Properties from the right-click menu. Enter ## in the Initial Value edit box. Click OK.

How do I resize columns in a table?	
1.	To narrow a column in a table, select the top cell and click Select Column from the right-click menu.
2.	Place your mouse over the red handle at the right center position. The cursor should change to a horizontal bi-directional arrow. Drag the handle to the left to narrow the column.
3.	To equally size the remaining columns select these controls and click Resize Table (Horizontal)  from the Form Tools palette.

How do I add a column in the middle of a table?	
	Select the top cell of the column to the left of the position that you want to insert the column
	Select the right-click <i>Select Column</i> menu item
	Select the right-click <i>Copy</i> menu item
	Select the right-click <i>Paste</i> menu item
	Double click the selected items and assign the new tag name
	Press the up arrow key once to align the pasted column back and same horizontal row
	Select the upper left cell of the table
	Select the right-click <i>Select Table</i> menu item
	Click on the <i>Resize Table(horizontal)</i> tool bar 

How do I change controls to a different type?	
1.	Select one or more
2.	Select the right-click Change Type menu item
3.	Select the new type

How do I tag name multiple controls?	
1.	Select one or more controls from the workspace or in a table. Note that you can use the right-click <i>Select Column</i> or the right-click <i>Select Row</i> menu items.
2.	Double click the selected cells to display the Multiple Items Properties dialog
3.	In the Multiple Items Properties dialog enter the generic root tag name for the selected controls. The system will automatically tag name the selected controls with the root name you entered and will add unique ‘_#’ suffixes where the # is the order in which the controls were selected.

How do I add a chart control to plot table values?	
1.	Following the previous FAQs, add a table with 3 columns and 11 rows. Initialize the first row as of cells as No., Volts and Amps. Initialize the second through eleventh rows in column 1 as 1-10. Tag name rows 2-11 in column 1 as Test_1 through Test_10. Tag name rows 2-11 in column 2 as Volts_1 through Volts_10. Tag name rows 2-11 in column 3 as Amps_1 through Amp_10. Rows 2-11 in columns 2 and 3 should be numeric input fields.
2.	Add a chart control to the workspace by selecting Insert > Chart in the Form Controls panel. Click in the workspace to place the control. Double click to open the Chart Control Properties.
3.	Under the Chart Setup tab: Label the X-axis as Test Label scale group 1 as Amps Label scale group 2 as Volts Set the Chart Mode to be Line and the Chart Type to be Normal
4.	Under the Trace Setup tab: Define trace 1 and 2 X-axis as follows: Test_#!1:10 Define trace 1 Y-axis as follows: Volts_#!1:10 Define trace 2 Y-axis as follows: Amps_#!1:10 Select colors, symbols and line styles. Set the scale group for trace 2 to 2 in the dropdown box.

How do I ‘Safe Multiply’ values?	
1.	Using the table created in the preceding FAQ, copy/paste column 3. Change the text display in the first cell to read Power. Rename the tags for rows 2-11 as Power_1 through Power_10 and set as Read Only. In this example column 4 cells are to be defined as the product of the volts and amps in each row, however the calculation should only be done if both fields have values.
2.	In the first calculated control enter the following in the On Update tab of the Script Editor: .this = SafeMultiply(.Volts_1 , .Amps_1)
3.	Copy and Paste this script to the remaining cells in the row using the right-click menu.

How do I add a graphic that can accept images during form entry?	
1.	Add an image control to the workspace and size as desired.
2.	Double click on the control to open the Image Properties dialog. Give the control a tag name, uncheck Read Only, check Select During Data Entry.
3.	Click on the Borders button and set a value other than zero. Check Draw on Exterior.

How do I populate data from prior test dates?	
1.	Create a table with two rows and five columns to populate current data in the first column and prior test data in columns to the right.
2.	Tag name the first cell in row 1 as 'Volts' and set as a numeric input Tag name the remaining cells as 'db_Volts_1' through 'db_Volts_4' and set as numeric displays
3.	Tag name the first cell in row 2 as 'Amps' and set as a numeric input Tag name the remaining cells as 'db_Amps_1' through 'db_Amps_4' and set as numeric displays
4.	Double click the upper left cell in the table
5.	Select the Script button
6.	Select the On Enter tab
7.	Add the following line on the On Enter Tab call Application.GetHistDataForTags(form.FormId, "Volts,Amps")
8.	Select the 'Run At Start' checkbox

How do I associate a test date with current and prior data?	
1.	Using the table created in the previous FAQ, add a row of text displays above the table.
2.	Tag name the first cell in the newly created row as TestDate (Note: this assumes standard Header information is used)
3.	Tag name the remaining cells as 'db_TestDate_1' through 'db_TestDate_4'
4.	Modify the scripting in FAQ 20 Item #7 to call Application.GetHistDataForTags(form.FormId, "TestDate,Volts,Amps")

How do I add a trend chart to a form?	
1.	If you would like to trend a field with a tag name Amps double click on the field.
2.	Select the Script Button
3.	Select the On Enter tab
4.	Add the following line call Application.GetHistDataForTags(form.FormId, "Amps")
5.	Select the 'Run At Start' checkbox
6.	Insert a Chart Control using the chart  toolbar item and size the control as desired.
7.	Double click on the chart control
8.	Select the 'Chart Mode' drop-down and pick the 'Line' option
9.	Click on the Trace Setup tab
10.	Add the following line to the Y axis of the first trace Db_Amps_#1:10
11.	Select the Lines tab
12.	Insert the following in the Line 1 variable cell db_Amps_2sigmaA
13.	Insert the following in the Line 2 variable cell db_Amps_2sigmaB

How do I associate a unit of measure description with numeric data?	
1.	To associate the unit label 'Watts' with a numeric entry add a text input control with the tag name Value.
2.	Add the following script to the On Update tab to report a numeric value with 2 digit decimal place accuracy followed by the descriptive label Watts .this = AddUnits(.this,2,"Watts")
3.	This data is text and may need to be used in calculations. To multiply this control by 2 enter the following script into a numeric display control in the On Update tab .this = SafeMultiply(2 , ToNumber(.Value))

How do I rename a field and still support data saved with the old name?	
1.	To rename a field Temperature to TempC perform the following steps.
2.	Double click on the field
3.	Rename the tag name
4.	Select the Script Button
5.	Select the On Update tab
6.	Add the following lines If GetVar("Temperature") <> Empty then .this = .Temperature .Temperature = Empty End if

How do I set tag names to match a description label?	
1.	Select an even number of Read Only (positioned to the left) and Input controls (positioned to the right)
2.	Select the Set Tag to Label right-click menu item to match the tag name of the Input controls to the Read Only label control.

How do I set a column 'c' equal to the product of column 'a' and column 'b' using a for / next loop?	
1.	Double click in the top left cell of the table
2.	Select the Script Button
3.	Select the On Update Tab
4.	Insert the following text: For I = 1 to 10 TmpA = GetNdxVar("a",i) TmpB = GetNdxVar("b",i) TmpC = SafeMultiply(TmpA, TmpB) Call SetNdxVar("c",I,TmpC) Next

How do I echo 'As Found' test values to 'As Left' test values for a tag named x?	
1.	Add an as found field and set the tag name to x_AsFound
2.	Add an as left field and set the tag name to x_AsLeft
3.	Shift double click on the as found field
4.	Select the On Update Tab
5.	Insert the following text: Call Application. UpdateAsFoundAsLeft(.FormId, "x_AsFound", "x_AsLeft")

How do I change appearance and add a deficiency for values that are out of tolerance?	
1.	To use this feature you must use the 'Comments and Deficiencies Variable' subform
2.	Add a numeric input control and tag name it Test1
3.	For Test 1, assuming minimum and maximum expected values of 3 and 10, add the following script to the On Update tab <pre> if .this <> Empty and (.this <3 or .this >10) then .this!color = CLR_RED Call AddAutoDeficiency ("Test1"," Test 1 result not within expected range.") else .this!color = CLR_BLACK Call ClearAutoDeficiency ("Test1") end if </pre> This scripting will display the input value in red on the form and print the text, as specified above, as a Deficiency. If the value is later corrected, the deficiency comment will be removed.

How do I add a Help Screen to a form?	
1.	Double-click in the form at any location that has the grid dots to display the form properties script dialog
2.	Select the Define Help button in the Form Properties dialog
3.	Enter text or paste from another source.
4.	The text will now be displayed any time the user presses the F1 key on the form

How do I show/hide a subform?	
1.	To hide/show a subform based on a checkbox add a checkbox with the tag name ShowSubform.
2.	Add the following line of scripting to the On Update tab of your subform call SetVisible("__SubformName", .ShowSubform)
3.	If your form could grow larger than one page due to showing and hiding subforms, then you'll need to put an empty read-only Text control with the tag "BottomOfPage" at the point where you want the pagination.
4.	If you have multiple subforms that follow one another, where some may be hidden, then you need to check "Link With Control Above" in the subform properties.
5.	An alternate method for showing/hiding can be used as shown in the script below. Add this script to the On Update tab of your subform. if .ShowSubForm then call SetVisible("__SubformName", 1) else call SetVisible("__SubformName", 0) end if

How do I add a table that grows?	
1.	Create a table in a subform. Build the table to have the first row of controls to be labels and add only one row below this for data input. Uniquely tag name each control in the second row (input fields) like the following examples: FirstTag_1, SecondTag_1. Add the tab order to the table.
2.	Add the subform to your form.
3.	In the form, double-click on the subform to view its properties.
4.	Check the 'Allow Table to Grow' and 'Auto Add New Line to End of Table' options.

How do I add a table that grows to a defined size?	
1.	Create a table in a subform. Build the table to have the first row of controls to be labels and add only one row below this for data input. Uniquely tag name each control in the second row (input fields) like the following examples: FirstTag_1, SecondTag_1. Add the tab order to the table.
2.	Add the subform to your form.
3.	In the form, double-click on the subform to view its properties.
4.	Check the 'Allow Table to Grow' option.
5.	Add a numeric input control (select to hide on print if desired). For this example the subform name is 'GrowingTable' and the numeric input is tag named 'HowBig'
6.	In Form Properties add the following script to the On Update tab: Call SetNumRows("__GrowingTable", .HowBig) Please note the subform name is preceded by a double underscore

How do I add a table that grows with indexing?	
1.	Create a table in a subform. Build the table to have the first row of controls to be labels and add only one row below this for data input. If you want your first column to be the "index" column have this column be Read-Only numeric fields. Tag name the first control in row 2 'RowNdx_1'. Add the following script to the On Update tab of this control: RecordNdx = 1 .this = RecordNdx Uniquely tag name all other controls in the second row (input fields) like the following examples: FirstTag_1, SecondTag_1. Add the tab order to the table.
2.	Add the subform to your form.
3.	In the form, double-click on the subform to view its properties.
4.	Check the 'Allow Table to Grow' and 'Auto Add New Line to End of Table' options.

How do I add a table that grows to a defined size with indexing?	
1.	Create a table in a subform. Build the table to have the first row of controls to be labels and add only one row below this for data input. If you want your first column to be the “index” column have this column be Read-Only numeric fields. Tag name the first control in row 2 ‘RowNdx_1’. Add the following script to the On Update tab of this control: <pre>RecordNdx = 1</pre> <pre>.this = RecordNdx</pre> Uniquely tag name each control in the second row (input fields) like the following examples: FirstTag_1, SecondTag_1. Add the tab order to the table.
2.	Add the subform to your form.
3.	In the form, double-click on the subform to view its properties.
4.	Check the ‘Allow Table to Grow’ option.
5.	Add a numeric input control (select to hide on print if desired). For this example the subform name is ‘GrowingTable’ and the numeric input is tag named ‘HowBig’
6.	In Form Properties add the following script to the On Update tab: <pre>Call SetNumRows("__GrowingTable", .HowBig)</pre> Please note the subform name is preceded by a double underscore.

How do I add symbols and special characters to a form?	
1.	Symbols and Greek characters are often used as labels in “read only” fields. These might include Ω, Φ, δ, π, μ, ° and many others. These characters can exist along with normal text in any field without any special font selection.
2.	Browse to the website http://unicode-table.com/en/, locate the desired character, and copy it to the clipboard. In the form editor, open the text properties and paste the character into the text.

How do I make different logos appear on forms depending on customer or user name?	
1.	Add multiple logo files to the image control in either subform Logo1 or Logo2.
2.	Add scripting similar to this to the On Initial Update tab of the image control. <pre> select case .PdbUserName case "User 1" .logoRhs = 0 case "User 2" .logoRhs = 1 case "User 3" .logoRhs = 2 case else .logoRhs = 3 end select </pre>
3.	Use .PdbCustomerName as an alternative. Make sure the name in quotes "User 1" exactly matches the name as entered in the Address Book. The number (0,1,2,3,,,) indicates which logo is used from the order they appear in the image control.

How do I change the background color of a text or numeric control?	
1.	Script example of changing background color of a control, based upon a checkbox with tagname ph3. Place this script in the On Update tab of the field. <pre> if .ph3 then .this!bgcolor = clr_white else .this!bgcolor = clr_gray20 end if </pre>

How do I use the Form Schema to make changes to a form and not affect previously saved results?	
1.	Open the form or subform properties and increment the Form Schema value.
2.	Use the following scripting to determine the schema value for saved results. This would be added to the On Initial Update tab of the form that is going to be changed. Schema = GetVar("SavedFormSchema") Note: If you need to update the schema of a subform, you can also use "HeaderSavedSchema" (replace Header with the applicable subform name), placing that scripting on the On Initial Update tab of the subform.
3.	A scripting example that could be used to show either an original or updated Header subform: <pre>Schema = GetVar("HeaderSavedSchema") if IsBlankString(Schema) Or Schema = 1 then call SetVisible("__Header - Basic Info", 0) call SetVisible("__Header - Basic Info New", 1) else call SetVisible("__Header - Basic Info", 1) call SetVisible("__Header - Basic Info New", 0) end if</pre> This example assumes that you have subforms 'Header – Basic Info' and 'Header – Basic Info New' laying on top of each other on the Header subform.

How do I enter N/A to a numeric input field?	
1.	Enter the following script into the OnUpdate tab of the control <pre>call RunTagCmd("TagName","SetTextMap 0,N/A")</pre>
2.	During data entry, inputting a value of '0' will get replaced with N/A

How do I call a dropdown list using scripting?	
1.	Open the subform called User Data.
2.	In the form properties, open the Data tab in the form scripting.
3.	Add a list definition using the following format: ListName: Item1 Item2 Item3 :END
4.	In the On Initial Update tab of the dropdown box control, add the following line of script: .this!list = application.ReadDataMultiLineFromTag(.FormId, "ListName:")

How do I add a custom column to the Results listing?	
1.	Select an available field in Tools > Database Admin > Database Options > User Defined Fields.
2.	Enter a Form Tag (tagname) and an appropriate Display Name for any unused date, numeric or string field.
3.	Once a form tagname is entered, the column will appear in the Results list. The column will be named using the display name.
4.	When new results are saved, any value associated with the tagname on the form will appear in that column.

How do I add a multiline dialog popup for Comment/Deficiency entry?	
1.	This is only used with the dynamic growing Comments subform.
2.	Open the Comments subform and the scripting of the form properties.
3.	Add the following line of scripting to the On Initial Update tab of the form scripts: call SetVar("FormUseMultilineEditDlg", 1)